NATIVE: FROM RESEARCH TO THE WORK ATOM

From one line to a working company

Where to look, which goal, how to cut it, how it runs, and how it gets cheaper. One small lending company, top to bottom and back up.



at every rung, the same six questions: the compass

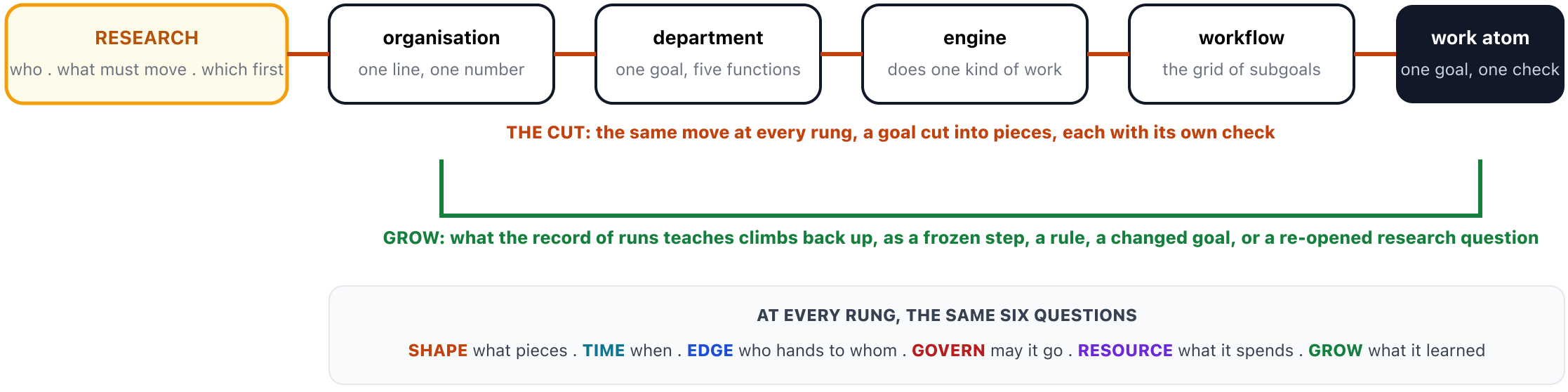
SHAPE . TIME . EDGE . GOVERN . RESOURCE . GROW

Draft for the founder's read, 2026-10-12. Figures in the research part are examples, marked as such.

THE MAP OF THIS DECK

One ladder, walked down and then back up

Research sits above the ladder and decides where the first cut points. The cut goes down, rung by rung, to the smallest piece of work. The record climbs back up and changes the cut.



AT EVERY RUNG, THE SAME SIX QUESTIONS

SHAPE what pieces . **TIME** when . **EDGE** who hands to whom . **GOVERN** may it go . **RESOURCE** what it spends . **GROW** what it learned

The first deck walked the last two rungs. This one starts above the ladder and comes all the way down, then up.

PART I, RESEARCH

Before you cut anything, answer three questions

Research is not a report. It is three answers that decide where the first cut points. Without them the compass cuts the wrong goal, neatly.

QUESTION A

Who is it for?

One kind of person, their pain, what they do about it today, and what they would pay to make it go away.

QUESTION B

What must move?

The one number the company exists to move. It becomes the check on the company's goal, and every subgoal inherits it.

QUESTION C

Which first?

Of all the goals that would move the number, the one with the most impact and the firmest ground. That is where the first cut points.

THE RULE FOR RESEARCH

Every answer is a sentence with a number and a source beside it. A number without a source is an assumption, and assumptions get a letter so they can be checked later.

In the compass these three live in SHAPE (the lens: where to cut) and in Priority (the impact axis: what must move). On the Native site, Market and people and Long-term direction are still to be written.

QUESTION A

Who is it for?

One person, drawn sharply enough that you could recognise them in a queue. Example answer for a small lending company; the figures are examples, to be replaced by your findings.

Ask	Example answer	Source
Who	Salaried people earning 25,000 to 60,000 a month, in cities of 1 to 5 million	example, A
Their pain	A sudden need of 1 to 3 lakh: a hospital bill, a school fee, a wedding	example, A
What they do today	Banks refuse under 5 lakh or take 2 weeks; they borrow from a relative or a lender at 3 to 5 percent a month	example, B
What they would pay	A fair rate for money in hand within 2 days and no humiliation	example, B
How many	Enough in one city to lend to 100 a month in year one	example, C

A The income band and city size are assumed; check against one month of applications.

B The informal rate and the 2-day wish come from conversations, not a survey; ask 30 people.

C The 100-a-month volume is a target, not a finding; the first 90 days will say.

WHAT THIS DECIDES

The customer sets the first cut: "paid out in 2 days" is a phase deadline on every grid below, and "refused by banks" makes identity and income checks the heart of the work.

QUESTION B

What must move?

One number the company exists to move, readable from its own record. It becomes the check on the company's goal, and every department, engine and subgoal below inherits a piece of it.

THE COMPANY'S GOAL, WITH ITS CHECK

Give small loans to salaried people the banks turn away.

Done, every month, when: money in hand within 2 working days for 9 of 10 approved, and 97 of 100 repay on time.

Two numbers, because one alone can be gamed: pay out fast by lending to anyone, or repay well by lending to nobody. Together they describe the company.

Candidate number	Readable from the record?	Keep?
loans paid out within 2 days	yes, every payout has a date	yes
on-time repayment	yes, every EMI has a date	yes
customer happiness	no, not without asking them	later
market share	no, needs outside data	no

D The 97 of 100 is assumed for small salaried loans; replace with your own after 200 loans.

In Native this is the impact axis: what the work must move, set before it runs and read back when it closes. Ruled 2026-09-25, not yet built.

QUESTION C

Which first?

List the goals that would move the number. Score each on impact (how much it moves) and ground (how well you know how). Pick the one with the most impact on the firmest ground. That is where the first cut points.

Candidate goal	Moves the number by	Impact	Ground	Pick
Give one customer a small loan, end to end, in 2 days	**the whole number; nothing else counts until this works**	**high**	**known**	**FIRST**
Collect this month's EMIs on time	the repayment half; needs loans to exist	high	known	second
Find 100 customers a month	volume, not the number itself	medium	unknown	later
Partner with an employer for salary-linked loans	repayment, maybe; a bet	medium	unknown	later
Build an app	nothing by itself	low	known	no

In Native this is Priority's job, ranking by impact. A goal without a number cannot be ranked; that is why question B comes before C.

THE HINGE

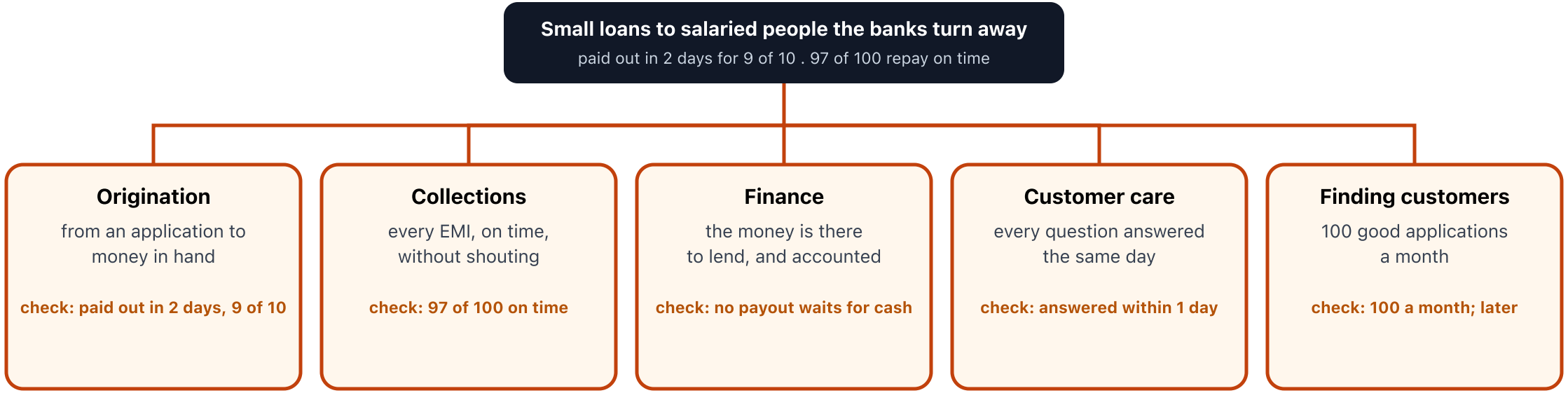
Research decides where the lens points. The compass decides how the work is cut.

From here on, the same move at every rung: take a goal with its check, ask one question, cut, give every piece its own check.

PART II, THE CUT: RUNG 1, THE ORGANISATION

The company's goal, cut into departments

First question, SHAPE: what pieces does the company's goal have? Follow the seams of the work. Each department gets one goal and one check, inherited from the company's number.

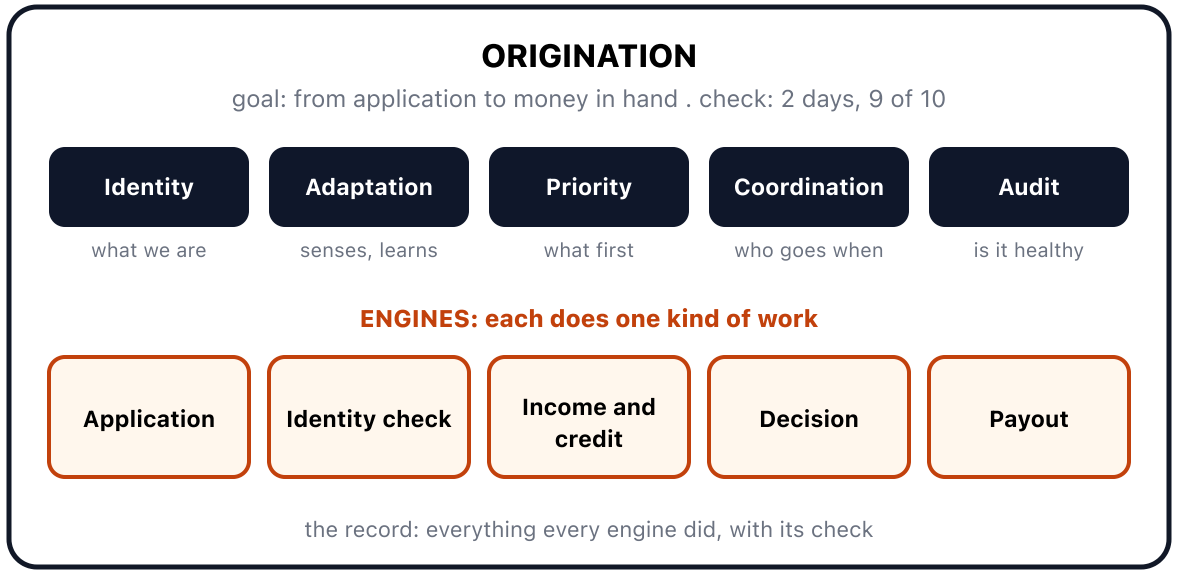


Research chose the first department: Origination, because question C picked "one loan, end to end". The others are drawn now and started later, when their pain appears.

RUNG 2, THE DEPARTMENT

Every department is born the same way

A department is one goal with its check, five functions that keep it honest, and the engines that do its work. The same shape at every level; that is what lets one rule grow the whole company.



THE FIVE FUNCTIONS, IN PLAIN WORDS

Identity says what the department is for and what it never does. Adaptation watches the record and proposes changes. Priority says what comes first. Coordination keeps two engines from tripping over each other. Audit asks whether the whole is healthy.

THE SAME CUT, ONE RUNG DOWN

Origination's goal cut on SHAPE gives the five engines on the left. These are the five pieces from the first deck.

Collections, Finance and the others get the same five functions on their first day, mostly empty, and fill as their pain appears.

PART III, RUNGS 3 TO 5: ENGINE, WORKFLOW, WORK ATOM

One loan, all six questions asked

The five engines, crossed with four phases, read on all six questions. Eleven subgoals, each with one goal and one check. This is the grid the first deck built one question at a time.

	1. Apply day 0	2. Check within 4 hours	3. Decide within 1 working day	4. Pay out within 2 working days
A. Application take the form and documents	**A1. Take the form and the documents** done when: form complete, 3 documents in officer · auto 4 min, 1 call	**A2. Ask for anything missing** done when: the missing item named, customer told officer · auto 2 min, 1 call	no work here	no work here
B. Identity check the person is who they say	**B1. Customer uploads an ID** done when: a readable ID on file customer · auto 0 min, 0 calls	**B2. Match the ID to the photo and the registry** done when: match confirmed, or mismatch named system · deny 0 min, 2 calls	no work here	no work here
C. Income and credit can they repay	**C1. Customer gives bank statements** done when: 6 months on file customer · auto 0 min, 0 calls	**C2. Read the statements, pull the credit score** done when: income and score on file, or a reason system · auto 0 min, 6 calls	no work here	no work here
D. Decision yes or no, on what terms	no work here	no work here	**D3. Compare with policy; set amount, rate, tenure** done when: terms within policy credit desk · ask 8 min, 1 call	no work here
E. Payout money sent, account opened	no work here	no work here	**E3. Draft the agreement** done when: agreement matches the terms system · auto 0 min, 2 calls	**E4. Send the money, open the account, tell the customer** done when: the bank confirms the credit finance · ask 5 min, 1 call

One line from the owner, three research answers, and two cuts became this. The owner only stamped two asks.

THE BOTTOM OF THE LADDER

The work atom: where the cut stops

A piece that cannot be split and still be work. One goal, one check, every run on record. Everything above it is made of these.

WORK ATOM C2

Read the bank statements, pull the credit score.

done when: 6 months of income on file and a score, or a named reason why not

SHAPE	a piece of Income and credit; the ground is not simple, so the system looks closer
TIME	phase 2 of 4; within 4 hours of the documents arriving
EDGE	receives statements from the customer; hands income and score to the decision
GOVERN	auto; stops the goal if no score can be pulled
RESOURCE	0 person-minutes, 6 system calls
GROW	after 40 runs: steady for salaried customers, so a split is proposed

WHY THE ATOM MATTERS

Every number in the research part is finally read here. "Paid out in 2 days" is true or false because of atoms like this one and their recorded times. The company's number is the sum of its atoms' checks.

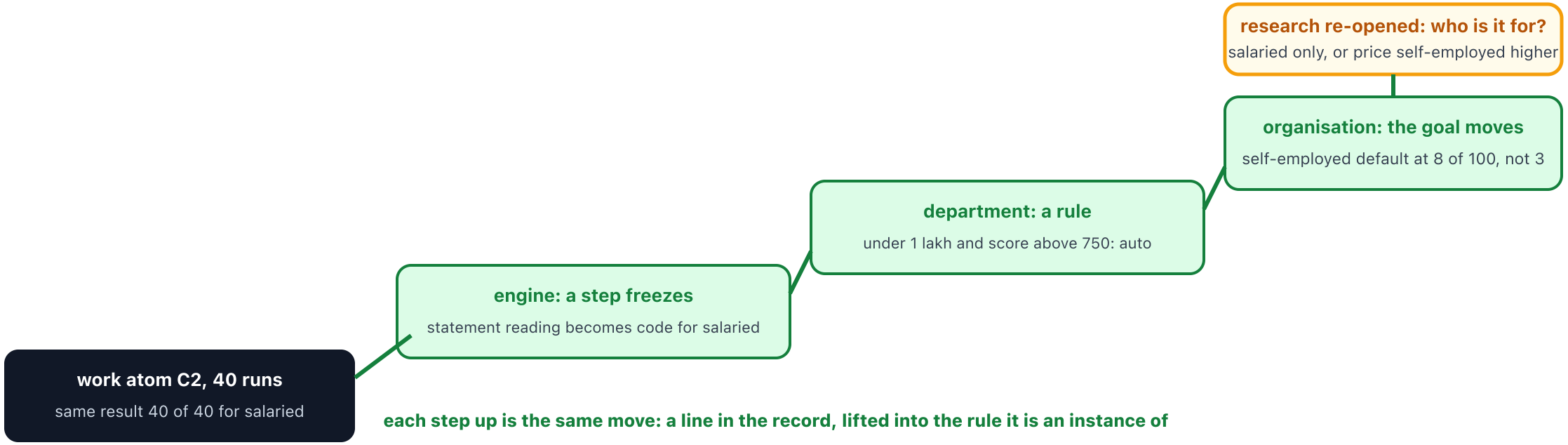
WHAT COMES NEXT

The atom's record is what climbs back up the ladder. Part IV.

PART IV, BACK UP THE LADDER

After 40 loans, the record climbs back up

GROW does not cut. It reads the record and lifts what repeated one rung up at a time, until it reaches the research questions and re-opens one of them.



This is why research is not a one-time report. The record answers the research questions better than the first interviews did, and the loop runs again.

How Native makes this from one line

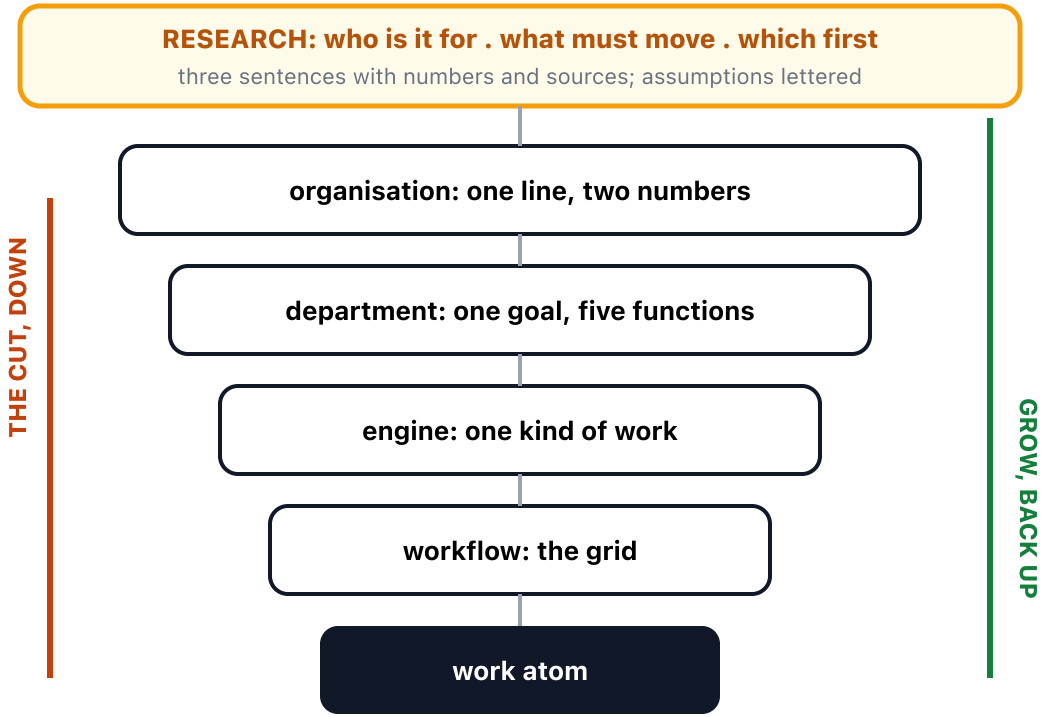
What the owner does, what the system does, and what is built today. Marks from the department page of the Native site, 2026-09-29.

#	The owner	The system	Today
1	types the organisation's name and one line of intent	Root asks until the intent is clear, decides the first department, builds it with its five functions from the template that fits	PARTLY BUILT
2	stamps the department's identity when it is good enough	Identity writes the goal, the rules and the done line; asks itself questions until they meet the standard	PARTLY BUILT
3	nothing	the first engine is made from the goal; it runs; it files its work with its check	BUILT IN CORE
4	stamps the two asks	every step runs auto, ask or deny as set; nothing leaves the record without a stamp	BUILT IN CORE
5	says an idea in words	Adaptation shapes it, prices it, asks "add an engine?"; on a stamp the line grows	PARTLY BUILT
6	nothing	a stamp given the same way again and again becomes a rule; a steady step freezes to code	PARTLY BUILT
7	speaks to Root again	a second department is born the same way; coordination appears when two clash	PARTLY BUILT
8	answers the three research questions	reads them as the lens and the impact number; ranks goals by impact	DESIGNED ONLY

Row 8 is the gap this deck points at: the research part has no home in the product yet, and no page on the site. Everything below it has at least a partial build.

ALL OF IT IN ONE PICTURE

Research above, the compass at every rung, the record climbing back



SHAPE
what pieces

TIME
when

EDGE
who hands to whom

asked of every rung, on every run

GOVERN
may it go

RESOURCE
what it spends

GROW
what it learned

the owner writes the line and stamps the asks

DO IT YOURSELF

From an idea to a company, in eight moves

1. **Who is it for?**
   One person, their pain, what they do today, what they would pay. Numbers with sources; assumptions lettered.
2. **What must move?**
   One or two numbers readable from your own record. They become the company's check.
3. **Which first?**
   Rank the goals by impact and firmness of ground. The first cut points there.
4. **Write the company's goal in one line, with its check.**
5. **Cut on SHAPE into departments, then into engines.**
   One goal and one check per piece, at every rung. Draw the other departments; start only the first.
6. **Cut on TIME; add EDGE, GOVERN, RESOURCE.**
   The grid of subgoals, down to the work atom. Empty cells stay empty.
7. **Run it. Stamp only the asks.**
8. **Let GROW climb.**
   Frozen steps, rules, a moved goal, a re-opened research question. Then go to move 1 again.

THE THREE RESEARCH MOVES

They are the only moves that need the outside world. Everything after them reads the company's own record.

THE SAME MOVE, EVERY RUNG

Company to department, department to engine, engine to subgoal: take a goal with its check, ask one question, cut, give each piece its check. Nothing else is needed to grow the tree.

THE PROMISE

First loan expensive, hundredth loan cheap, and the hundredth loan tells you who your customer really is.

TRY IT ON SOMEONE

A case question that leads a person to this system

Give this to someone who has never seen the compass. Then ask the follow-ups in order, only when they stall. A strong answer rebuilds the first deck on its own.

THE QUESTION

A friend has just started a small lending company. One product: personal loans of 1 to 5 lakh for salaried people the banks turn away. She has three staff, a laptop, and no process. She wants a company that can give out a loan without her touching it.

Organise her work so that: (a) a loan is paid out within two working days; (b) she only looks at the things that truly need her; (c) the hundredth loan costs less to process than the first; and (d) after a hundred loans she knows better than today whom to lend to.

Draw it. You may ask me anything about her business.

If they stall, ask	It leads to
Whom should she lend to, and what one number should she watch?	research: who, what must move
How would she know one loan is done?	one goal, one check
What are the pieces of one loan?	**SHAPE**
When does each piece happen, and by when?	**TIME**
Who does each piece, and who hands to whom?	**EDGE**
Which pieces may run without her?	**GOVERN**
What does each piece cost her, in minutes?	**RESOURCE**
What should change after a hundred loans, and how would she know?	**GROW**

Scoring: a check on the goal; pieces with their own checks; a grid with honest empty cells; named hand-offs; auto versus ask; a cost per piece; a learning loop that changes the cut. Six of seven is the compass, found alone.

IN ONE SENTENCE

Research says where to look. The compass cuts the goal down to the work atom. The record climbs back up and changes where to look. The owner writes one line and stamps the asks.

That loop, run at every rung, is a company.

Source: Native, the compass (axes and families); the department page and its journeys J1 to J7; the first deck, One goal, many subgoals. Draft, 2026-10-12.